



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Everyone makes mistakes!



Learning Outcome

Analyze issues relating to different topics and their solution in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about solving problems.
- I can report facts about events or actions.
- I can talk about my work responsibilities.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever made a serious mistake at work or at school? What happened?
- What did you do to fix the mistake?





Let's Explore!

Adam gets **reprimanded***!

* When you "reprimand" someone, you express extreme displeasure at their behavior.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Mr. Brown: Come on in Adam, and have a seat.

Adam: Thanks.

Mr. Brown: How has your week gone? Mr. Brody called me to check if you were settling in.

Adam: Okay, I think.

Mr. Brown: I infer from that response that it could have been better. We need to talk about your performance this week. According to some of the other copy editors, you have not really been pulling your weight. The team says that you haven't pitched in as much as you could have.

Adam: What do you mean? I've done everything that I've been asked to do. I did the filing and the photocopying that Mr. Brody asked me to do. He claimed that I had done a good job.

Mr. Brown: Okay, but that was just the first day. What about the paper?

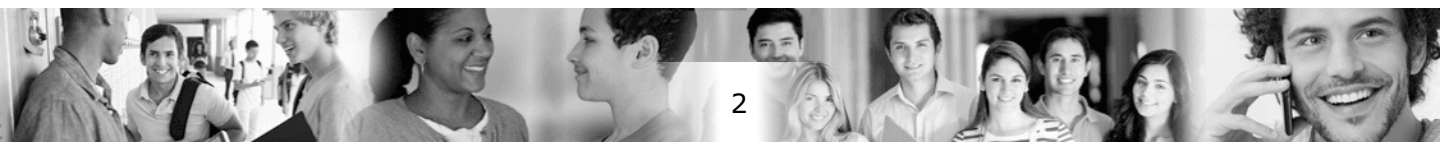
Adam: I put in a paper order over the phone.

Mr. Brown: Okay. You ordered the wrong type of paper. That paper can't be returned and is hugely expensive. We can't use it so we will have to see if we can sell it to another printer. Mr. Brody asked me how this mistake could have been made.

Adam: Your comments imply that I made a mistake, but I ordered what you told me to order.

Mr. Brown: I called the supplier and spoke to the sales rep. She reported that you were very unclear on the phone, and she had a hard time understanding you. In the words of the rep, you really "muddled it up." She suggested that you get the order straight before you make the call. Adam, if you are unclear about any part of this job, you need to ask questions and make sure you know what you are doing. Mistakes in this business are hard to fix and can be very costly.

Adam: Okay. I'm sorry. I'll do it better next week.





Let's Practice!

Adam finds out why he is being reprimanded.

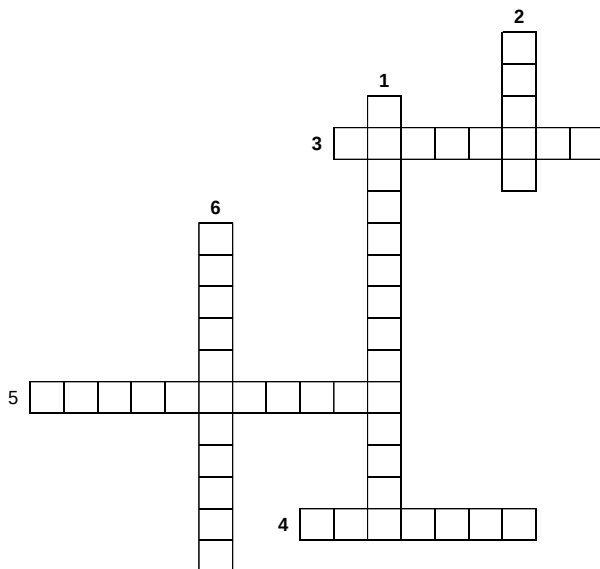
Instructions: Read the clues. Write the words in the corresponding boxes to correctly complete the crossword.

Down

1. to do your part (3 words)
2. to form an opinion or guess that something is true because of the information that you have
6. to understand correctly (2 words)

Across

3. to make a mess of (2 words)
4. to contribute toward a general effort (2 words)
5. how well a person, machine, etc. does a piece of work or an activity



Let's Practice!

Adam is not pulling his weight.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Circle the incorrect words. Write the correction on top of the incorrect words.

1. Mr. Brody called me to check that you were settling in.
2. He claimed which I had done a good job.
3. Mr. Brody asked me who this mistake could have been made.
4. She reported which you were very unclear on the phone.
5. She suggested how you get the order straight before you make the call.





Extension Activity

Fix the mistake.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On a piece of paper, write down five events that made your week a very bad one at work or school. (You can invent those events, or you can use Adam's bad week).
- Exchange lists of mistakes with a partner.
- For each of your partner's mistakes, write down a few sentences describing what you would do to fix the mistakes.
- Read the mistakes and your solutions to your class or a group.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a list of possible mistakes.

☐ ☐

I write solutions to my partner's mistakes.

☐ ☐

I read the mistakes and solutions aloud to a group.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to pull your weight** (expression): to do your part
e.g. According to some of the other copy editors, you have not really been pulling your weight.
- **to infer** (verb): to form an opinion or guess that something is true because of the information that you have
e.g. I infer from that response that it could have been better.
- **to muddle up** (verb): to make a mess of
e.g. In the words of the rep, you really "muddled it up."
- **to pitch in** (verb): to start to do something as part of a group, especially something helpful
e.g. The team says that you haven't pitched in as much as you could have.
- **hugely** (adjective): extremely
e.g. That paper can't be returned, and it is hugely expensive.
- **performance** (noun): how well a person, machine, etc. does a piece of work or an activity
e.g. We need to talk about your performance this week.
- **to get something straight** (expression): to understand correctly or make something clear
e.g. She suggested that you get the order straight before you make the call.





Learning Points

Quoting, Reporting and Interpreting

You use a number of different phrases or sentence structures to talk about what other people have said or written.

Look at the chart for an outline of some phrases you can use to quote, report or interpret others' speech.

Phrase	Meaning	Example
I infer from	interpret what you read or hear	<i>I infer from that response that it could have been better.</i>
According to	refer directly to what someone said or wrote	<i>According to some of the other copy editors, you have not really been pulling your weight.</i>
_____ says ...	refer directly to what someone said or wrote	<i>The team says that you haven't contributed as much as you could have.</i>
Your comments imply ...	interpret what you read or hear	<i>Your comments imply that I made a mistake, but I ordered what you told me to order.</i>
In the words of ...	refer directly to what someone said or wrote	<i>In the words of the rep, you really "muddled it up."</i>





Learning Points

Reported Structures: Types of Clauses

You use different types of clauses when you report what you have heard or read.

You can use three types of clauses:

1. That-clauses

You use that-clauses to **report statements**.

*He claimed **that I had done a good job**.*

2. Wh-clauses

You use wh-clauses to **report questions with wh-words** (why, when, how etc.)

*Mr. Brody asked me **how this mistake could have been made**.*

3. If-clauses

You use if-clauses to **report yes/no questions**.

*Mr. Brody called me to check **if you were settling in**.*

Examples:

- *She reported that you were very unclear on the phone and she had a hard time understanding you.*
- *She suggested that you get the order straight before you make the call.*

